



THE FALL OF RICHMOND

On April 2, 1865, General Lee sent word to Jefferson Davis that Richmond should be abandoned because Confederate lines were irretrievably broken. That night the exodus from the capital began, and chaos quickly ensued. Confederate troops torched hundreds of buildings, the arsenal exploded, warships on the James were blown up, and starving mobs looted shops and houses. The following day the Union Army was greeted by smoldering, eerily silent ruins.

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